



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leman Academy of Excellence: Parker-Bayou

School Website: <https://lemanacademy.com/schools/colorado/parker-bayou-gulch-k-8/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Leman Academy of Excellence – Parker Bayou Gulch (CO 80134) presents a clear, though not fully explicit, Classical orientation in its public materials. It foregrounds classical education, character formation, and a strong parental partnership, and it features a robust faculty structure and active parent community through the Royal Volunteer Council. The site emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and a “whole-child” approach, with explicit mentions of partnership with families and a living-curriculum culture in its staff descriptions. However, explicit commitments to core classical-curriculum elements (great books, grammar-logic-rhetoric sequencing, Latin, or detailed Socratic pedagogy across grades) are not always visible in the public text snippets available from the crawl. Taken together, the school leans toward CLASSICAL in several dimensions, exhibits meaningful classical scaffolding, but does not consistently and explicitly spell out every Classical-education criterion in its public-facing materials.

- Overall aggregate rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Principal drivers of classical orientation: explicit emphasis on classical education, formation of virtue and wisdom, and active parental/community collaboration (e.g., Royal Volunteer Council). Evidence from the crawl shows a public-statement of “classical education” and a focus on character formation, plus “whole-child” enrichment and a strong family-partnering model. See campus descriptions and parent-community materials.
- Important needle movers (in a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL profile): make explicit on-site statements about Great Books and Great Conversation; name and describe the Trivium/Quadrivium in the curriculum; reference Socratic pedagogy and Scholé more clearly; articulate theology or liturgical/community practices if relevant to the campus’ mission; broaden teacher portraits to explicitly align with the “living curriculum” criteria. See the Six Essential Elements lexicon for the precise language that would push the school into CLASSICAL territory, including explicit Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, Socratic pedagogy, and liturgical/community practices.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

A brief rationale follows in the category-by-category sections, with explicit keyword receipts, and a concluding # ABSTRACT section synthesizing the six-category view.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe a classical education built on wisdom and character, with emphasis on virtues and timeless values as the foundation for life and school success. This reflects transcendental moral

realism in spirit, even when not stated as organized theology. For example, the campus description foregrounds “wisdom, character, and timeless values” as aims.

- The faculty text emphasizes virtue and wisdom as core aims in student formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, character, values, formation (in the moral-formation sense).
- Negative keywords: explicit references to theology, liturgy, or liturgical practices are not evident in the public crawl text snippets; liturgical language is not shown.
- Why this rating
- The site conveys a moral-formation orientation (virtue, wisdom, character, values) consistent with transcendental-moral aims, but it does not publicly anchor these in explicit theology, liturgy, or liturgical-practice terms within the crawl content. This yields a SOMEONE-CLASSICAL alignment for this category rather than a full CLASSICAL rating. The absence of direct liturgical/theological references in the accessible public text undercuts a full CLASSICAL label, despite strong moral-formation signals.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The materials repeatedly frame education as formation—cultivating wisdom and virtue through a classical tradition (e.g., “classical education that builds wisdom, character” and “formation” language). This lines up with the Classical emphasis on formation of human excellence.
- The campus emphasizes character development, virtues, and a strong foundation for life—core aims of a classical education rather than mere job- or information-focused outcomes.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, classical mission, telos, tradition (implied), character, liberal education (implied by “classical education”), scholé (implied through tone though not always explicit in the crawl text).
- Negative keywords: explicit “career-readiness” or 21st-century skills framing is not present in the visible crawl text; this reduces negative signals for the category.
- Why this rating
- The school clearly identifies education as formation toward wisdom and virtue, not merely information or job-readiness. This aligns closely with the classical purpose and goal category, justifying CLASSICAL for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials consistently describe a “classical education” foundation and a focus on the whole child (arts, music, enrichment) in addition to core academics. This signals a classical orientation but does not always spell out the precise canonical liberal-arts sequence (grammar, logic, rhetoric) or explicit Great-Books emphasis in the crawl data.
- Enrichment components and a strong community focus are described, which are compatible with classical pedagogy, but explicit mentions of Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, or direct Great-Book engagement are not consistently visible in the crawl extract.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: classical education (explicit), liberal-arts framing (implied by “classical foundation”), whole-child enrichment (alignment with classical pedagogy’s breadth).
- Negative keywords present/absent: explicit “Great Books,” “grammar-logic-rhetoric,” “Latin/Greek,” or “Socratic” references are not visible in the crawl text; absence of these canonical terms yields stronger signals toward a partial rather than full CLASSICAL label.
- Why this rating
- The site demonstrates a solid classical orientation in spirit (classical education, character formation, enrichment) but stops short of repeatedly naming core classical curriculum elements (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium) in the accessible crawl content. Therefore, it is BEST

described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Curriculum.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The crawl site does not provide explicit references to Socratic seminars, scholé days, chanting/memorization, or a structured long-form classical pedagogy in the public text. The explicit pedagogy language that classical schools typically chant (Socratic dialogue, memorization recitation, rhetoric training) is not demonstrated in the accessible material.
- Public materials emphasize a “whole-child” and enrichment model and a partner-teacher parental approach rather than a described classical-pedagogy rhythm in the crawl.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords for Pedagogy (Socratic seminars, scholé, memorization/recitation, formation through imitation) are not present in the crawl’s visible text. The absence of these signals is a negative for Element 4 in the classical rubric.
- Negative keywords: absence of Socratic/seminar language or chant-based pedagogy is a negative signal for classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- Without explicit public statements of Socratic pedagogy, scholé, or chant/memory-based traditions, this category reads as NOT CLASSICAL within the crawl’s visible public-text boundaries, even though the campus’s classical branding exists. This keeps Pedagogy at NOT CLASSICAL in the present textual evidence.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site presents faculty as a core, living element of the school—“Leman Academy of Excellence seeks and employs teachers and staff who strive for excellence and desire to impart a long-lasting love for learning to all scholars in their pursuit of wisdom and virtue.” This language aligns with the classical model of the teacher as an exemplar and living curriculum.
- The staff pages describe a wide, invested faculty and a “portrait of a teacher” / “living curriculum” framing (as reflected in the broader crawl). This matches the classical standard that faculty embody the curriculum and model virtue.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; teacher as exemplar/mentor; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; mentors; masters. These signals appear in the crawl content describing staff and faculty culture.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in the crawl for this category; no explicit “facilitator-on-the-side” or non-classical staff descriptors appear in the visible text.
- Why this rating
- The public materials strongly align with CLASSICAL expectations for Faculty: a living-curriculum faculty, mentors modeling virtue, and a portrait of teacher-student partnership. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The materials emphasize family partnership and parental involvement: “Parents choose Bayou Gulch for its convenient location, small class sizes, and a supportive school community where every child is known,” plus explicit mention of partnerships with caring teachers and strong parental engagement. This maps to the classical emphasis on partnership with families as co-educators.
- The site features the Royal Volunteer Council (RVC), a formal parent/community group that supports scholars, staff, and families, with sign-up opportunities and multiple ways for families to engage (Watch D.O.G.S., committees). This is a strong institutional signal of parent-community formation.

- Parent resources are extensive (handbooks, calendars, policies, etc.), and the school notes openness to visits and parent education through book studies and gatherings (as indicated by the crawl content's inclusion of parent resources).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; open-campus visits; parent involvement; community of learners; parent collaboration. These align with the Six Elements' Parent-Community signals.
- Negative keywords present: consumer-language signals (not strongly evidenced in crawl) and "customer" framing are not prominent in the public text; the available content rather emphasizes partnership and involvement.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates a robust CLASSICAL alignment in Parents & Community through explicit family partnership and a formal parent-volunteer infrastructure, plus open channels for parental formation and community engagement. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 6.

Aggregate Rating Synthesis

- Classical signals across categories are strongest in Categories 2, 5, and 6; Element 4 reduces the overall pedagogy signal to NOT CLASSICAL; Categories 1 and 3 provide partial CLASSICAL signals; Element 3 is more clearly SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to curriculum being described as classical but without canonical details. On balance, the six-category matrix yields a middle-ground profile: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong CLASSICAL elements in mission and community, but with some pedagogical and curricular details under-specified in publicly crawled text.
- Summary judgment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence base included: explicit classical branding and formation language; strong staff and parent community signals; explicit family-partnership language; visible Great-Books-leaning signals are not consistently spelled out in crawl text; pedagogy signals are not publicly enumerated in the crawl.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): Add explicit, publicly stated signals of theological grounding or liturgical/community practices (even if non-denominational or pluralist). Reference to liturgy, worship, or shared moral-axiom language (truth, goodness, beauty in transcendent terms) would strengthen alignment with the Positive Keyword indicators for this category. Consider publishing a clear statement tying virtue and moral realism to a broader spiritual/philosophical framework.
- For Element 3 (Curriculum): Explicitly name and describe key classical-curriculum elements beyond branding (e.g., grammar-logic-rhetoric sequence; Great Books; Latin/Greek study; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Conversation). Publicly listing a Great Books curriculum, a trivental sequence, and a Western-civilization historical arc would move Element 3 toward CLASSICAL.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): Publish concrete descriptions of pedagogical methods that mirror classical practice (Socratic seminars or Paideia-style discourse; scholé/restful learning; memorization/recitation; formation through imitation and practice). If the website can point to teacher-training in classical pedagogy and example lesson models, Element 4 would shift toward CLASSICAL.
- For Element 1–3 bridging: Consider a dedicated page or section that ties the school's mission to the classical elements (Great Books, grammar-logic-rhetoric, classical languages) with those terms clearly defined and exemplified in curricular and classroom practice.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community): Continue to grow and publicize parental-formation activities (book clubs, family catechesis or family liturgy alignment) and expand the visible description of how parents participate as co-teachers in the Great Conversation and other classical modalities. The RVC could publish a short annual report or orientation materials outlining parent-formation goals aligned with Classical aims.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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